



ALWAYS ON TOP:
Students in the
AIIMS library

REUBEN SINGH

TOP 10 COLLEGES

2008		2007	2006
1	All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Delhi	1	1
2	Christian Medical College, Vellore	3	2
3	Armed Forces Medical College, Pune	2	3
4	JIPMER, Puducherry	4	4
5	Maulana Azad Medical College, Delhi	7	7
6	Grant Medical College, Mumbai	8	8
7	Kasturba Medical College, Manipal	5	6
8	Madras Medical College, Chennai	10	-
NEW 9	Seth GS Medical College, Mumbai	-	-
10	Lady Hardinge Medical College, Delhi	6	5

National rankings are derived from a combination of perceptual and factual scores. Colleges that did not provide factual information were not ranked.

* New entrants in the Top 10. (-) Not ranked in the Top 10.

MEDICINE

AIIMS retains its number one position while CMC, Vellore reclaims the second rank and Seth MS Medical College powers its way into the list of toppers

■ By Malini Bhupta

Institutions are bigger than individuals, which is why they survive much longer. And if the institution in question is the towering All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), even a high-decibel squabble between its director P. Venugopal and Union Minister for Health Anbumani Ramadoss does little to dent its image. For the sixth consecutive year, AIIMS has stuck to its numero uno position in the list of India's Best Colleges. Though other top medical colleges are striving hard to dislodge AIIMS from the top slot, both perception and reality show that its standards are difficult to match.

To any aspiring doctor, entry into AIIMS means being able to understand aspects of medicine and contributing to the growth of medical knowledge while working with the best brains in the field. Those who have passed out of the institution admit that what AIIMS offers is not possible elsewhere. Given the specialists it has, AIIMS gets to treat patients with complicated illnesses whom no one else is able to treat. It is number one in clinical services, accounting for almost half of the

national output in this area. It has many products and patents to its credit, including the HIV vaccine, multipurpose diagnostics for pulmonary and extra-pulmonary tuberculosis, the Vi-Vaccine for salmonella and the diagnostic test for Hepatitis C. AIIMS continues to make history, even as critics say the benefits of the hospital have a rub-off effect on the college.

AIIMS Medical Superintendent Dr Shakti Gupta believes that exposure to tremendous pressures—a daily patient intake of 10,000, for example—with limited infrastructure and human resources “gives unique opportunities to students and professionals”. “Just being in AIIMS is a unique experience,” he says.

Twelve years after INDIA TODAY began its rigorous ritual of ranking the country's best colleges, no college likes to be dislodged from its coveted position. Given that the first position in medicine has a permanent occupant, this year has seen tough competition between Christian Medical College (CMC), Vellore, and Armed Forces Medical College (AFMC), Pune, for the number two slot, with CMC, Vellore recapturing the position from AFMC. In its